

Paddle Battle Design Report

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Top-Level Design Description

Paddle Battle is an arcade game where the player tries to hit the ball behind the opponents' paddle. The goal is to get to 10 points before your opponent.

Design Pillars

The below design pillars identify the types of fun which are key to the user experience

- Competition
- Application of an Ability
- Social Interaction

Competition	Application of an Ability	Social Interaction
The core of Pong is head-to-head rivalry. Multiplayer amplifies this as players compete to outscore each other, creating tension and the drive to improve. Save files reinforce this by preserving game saves	Pong's simple mechanics create a skill-based challenge. Players develop quick reactions to track and return the ball, while also learning to outmaneuver their opponent.	Multiplayer Pong is played with two people in the same room, reacting to each other in real time. The fun here comes from experiencing shared moments together like the moment a comeback lands with someone right beside you to witness it. The save feature extends this beyond just a single sitting which lets players pick up an ongoing rivalry.

Audience & Marketing

This is designed to be a local multiplayer offline game. It is an arcade game for computers. This game is aimed at casual players of all ages who enjoy short, competitive sessions with someone physically nearby. Pong's simplicity widens the audience from beyond gamers. The save feature gives players with an ongoing rivalry a reason to return. Players most likely to engage with the save feature skew toward teens and young adults who live with family or have an established friend group to compete against.

Core Gameplay

This is a multiplayer game. Each player controls a paddle. They can move their paddle up and down. There is a ball that starts in the middle of the screen, if it moves towards the player's paddle the player should move the paddle, so it hits the ball back towards the other side of the screen. This prevents the opposing player from getting a point.

Ideally a player will hit the ball at an angle where the ball ends up behind the opposing player's paddle. When this happens, the opposing player cannot hit the ball back anymore, so the ball will then hit the wall behind the paddle. This will cause the player to gain a point, and the ball will reset to the centre of the screen. The first player to 10 points wins the game.

Controls

Enter - Pause

Escape - Unpause

Player 1:

A - Move paddle up

Z - Move paddle down

Player 2:

Up - Move paddle up

Down - Move paddle down

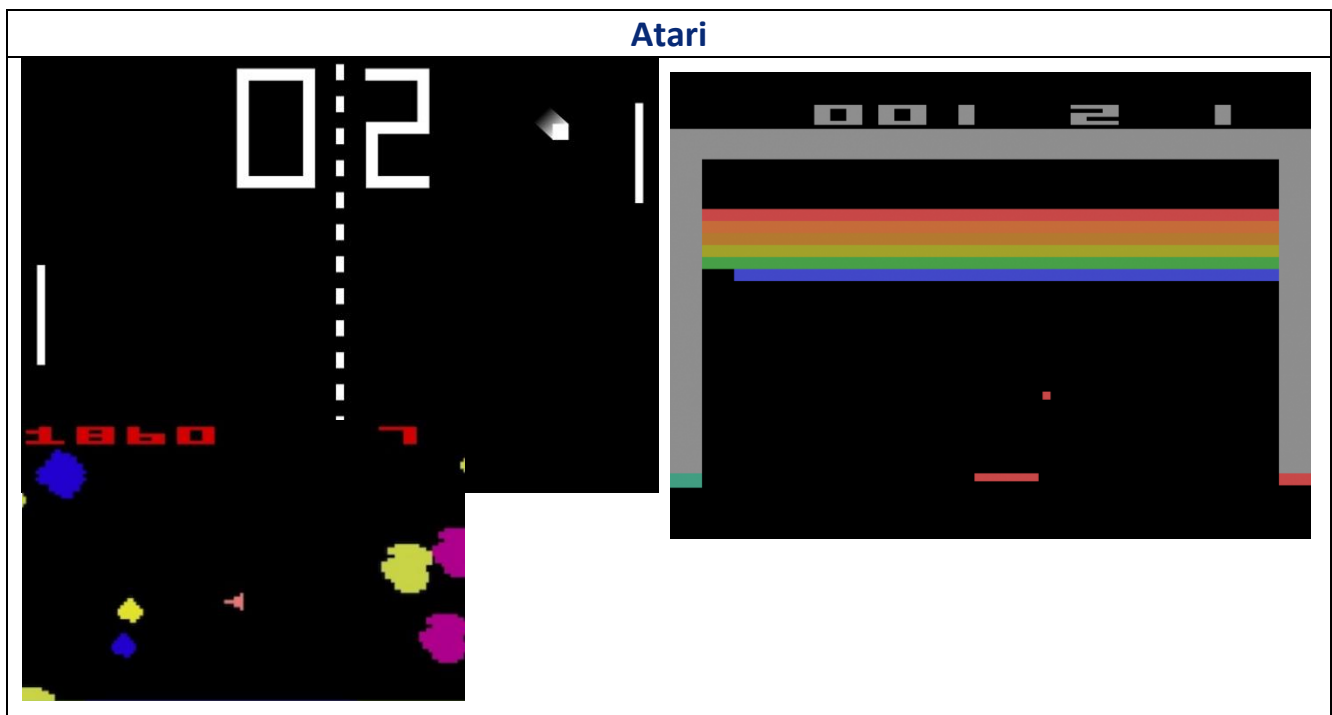
Gameplay Balance & Pacing

This is a local two-player arcade game where the first player to reach 10 points wins. Sessions are short by design as points are scored quickly when a player misjudges the ball's angle or reacts too slowly. This keeps games short and encourages rematches.

The save feature extends engagement beyond a single sitting by giving each session cumulative stakes without changing the session length itself. Pacing is driven by how the two players react in real time. Longer rallies build tension as both players trade returns successfully.

Tone & Aesthetics

The visual style is deliberately minimal as it draws directly from the look of early Atari arcade titles like the original Pong and Breakout. That era of games weren't minimal by artistic choice, it was constrained by the hardware it was on. But the result is visuals that look instantly as classic arcade games. This game leans into that rather than away from it.



Narrative

This is an offline multiplayer game without any explicit narrative. I do not intend to have dialog or characters speaking.

Business Model

Paddle Battle is a free-to-download game with no monetisation model. It will be made freely available to all users with no ads and no premium tiers.

The game is being developed as a portfolio project to demonstrate skills in game design and development. Its primary value is in the player experience and the learning gained through building it, rather than revenue generation.